

CS-GY 6033
Design and Analysis of Algorithms I

Lecture 4 | Part 1

News

News

- ▶ Homework 02 posted
 - ▶ Due Feb 19 @ 11:59 pm EST on Gradescope.
 - ▶ LaTeX template available.
- ▶ Quiz: next week, HW02, Lecture 03 and 04.

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Design and Analysis of Algorithms I

Lecture 4 | Part 2

Finishing Quicksort

mergesort

- ▶ We saw mergesort.
- ▶ **Divide:** split list directly down the middle
- ▶ **Conquer:** sort each half
- ▶ **Combine:** merge sorted halves together

merge does all the work

- ▶ In mergesort, we are lazy when we divide.
- ▶ So we have to work to combine.

$[4, 1, 3, 2] \rightarrow [4, 1], [3, 2] \rightarrow [4, 3], [2, 3] \rightarrow [1, 2, 3, 4]$

What if?

- ▶ Suppose we divide so that everything in left is smaller than everything in right:
- ▶ After sorting, no need for merge.
- ▶ $[5, 1, 3, 8, 6, 2] \rightarrow [1, 3, 2], [5, 8, 6]$

What if?

- ▶ Suppose we divide so that everything in left is smaller than everything in right:
- ▶ After sorting, no need for merge.
- ▶ $[5, 1, 3, 8, 6, 2] \rightarrow [1, 3, 2], [5, 8, 6]$
- ▶ This is what partition does!

Quicksort

```
def quicksort(arr, start, stop):  
    """Sort arr[start:stop] in-place."""  
    if stop - start > 1:  
        pivot_ix = random.randrange(start, stop)  
        pivot_ix = partition(arr, start, stop, pivot_ix)  
        quicksort(arr, start, pivot_ix)  
        quicksort(arr, pivot_ix+1, stop)
```


Time Complexity

- ▶ Average case: $\Theta(n \log n)$
- ▶ Worst case: $\Theta(n^2)$.
- ▶ Like with quickselect, worst case is **very rare**.

Mergesort vs Quicksort

- ▶ Mergesort has better worst case complexity.
- ▶ But in practice, Quicksort is often faster.
- ▶ Takes less memory, too.

Memory Requirements

- ▶ merges requires output array, $\Theta(n)$ additional space.
- ▶ partition works in-place, requires no additional space¹
- ▶ Example: sorting 3 GB of data with 4 GB of RAM.

¹Call stack for quicksort requires $\Theta(\log n)$ additional space.

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Design and Analysis of Algorithms I

Lecture 4 | Part 3

Data Structures and Dynamic Sets

Bookkeeping

- ▶ How do you store your books?

Bookkeeping

- How do you store your books?



Bookkeeping

- How do you store your books?



Bookkeeping: Tradeoffs

- ▶ Messy:
 - ▶ No upfront cost.
 - ▶ Cost to search is high.
- ▶ Organized
 - ▶ Big upfront cost.
 - ▶ Cost to search is low.
- ▶ “Right” choice depends on how often we search.

Data Structures and Algorithms

- ▶ **Data structures** are ways of organizing data to make certain operations faster.
- ▶ Come with an upfront cost (preprocessing).
- ▶ “Right” choice of data structure depends on what operations we’ll be doing in the future.

Abstract vs. Concrete

- ▶ An **abstract data type** (ADT) is a formal description of a type's **interface**.
- ▶ A **data structure** is a concrete strategy for implementing an abstract data type.
 - ▶ Describes how data is stored in memory.
 - ▶ How to access the data.

Example: Stacks

- ▶ A **stack** is an ADT which supports two operations:
 - ▶ push: put a new object on to the “top”
 - ▶ pop: remove and return item at the “top”
- ▶ Often implemented using **linked lists**.
- ▶ But can also be implement with **(dynamic) arrays**.

Main Idea

A given abstract data type can be implemented in several ways, but some data structures are more natural choices than others.

Queries: Easy to Hard

- ▶ We've been thinking about **queries**.
 - ▶ Given a collection of data, is x in the collection?
- ▶ Querying is a fundamental operation.
 - ▶ Useful in a data science sense.
 - ▶ But also frequently performed in algorithms.
- ▶ There are several situations to think about.

Situation #1: Static Set, One Query

- ▶ **Given:** an unsorted collection of n numbers (or strings, etc.).
- ▶ In future, you will be asked single query.
- ▶ Which is better: linear search or sort + binary search?
 - ▶ Linear search: $\Theta(n)$ worst case.
 - ▶ Binary search would require sorting first in $\Theta(n \log n)$ worst case

Situation #2: Static Set, Many Queries

- ▶ **Given:** an unsorted collection of n numbers (or strings, etc.).
- ▶ In future, you will be asked **many** queries.
- ▶ Which is better: linear search or sort + binary search?
 - ▶ Depends on number of queries!

Exercise

Suppose you have a static set of n items. How long will it take^a to perform k queries in total with:

1. linear search?
2. sort + binary search?

If $k = n/10$, which should you use?

What if $k = \log n$?

^aOn average. Assume the best case is rare.

Situation #3: Dynamic Set, Many Queries

- ▶ **Given:** a collection of n numbers (or strings, etc.).
- ▶ In future, you will be asked **many** queries *and* to **insert** or **remove** new elements.
- ▶ Best approach: ?

Binary Search?

- ▶ Can we still use binary search?
- ▶ **Problem:** To use binary search, we must maintain array in sorted order as we insert new elements.
- ▶ Inserting into array takes $\Theta(n)$ time in worst case.
 - ▶ Must “make room” for new element.
 - ▶ Can we use linked list with binary search?

Exercise

Suppose we have a collection of n elements. We make $n/4$ insertions and $n/4$ queries. How long will this take in total with

1. append to linked list + linear search?
2. maintain sorted array + binary search?

Today

- ▶ Introduce (or review) **binary search trees**.
- ▶ BSTs support fast queries *and* insertions/deletion.
- ▶ Preserve sorted order of data after insertion/deletion.
- ▶ Can be modified to solve many problems efficiently.
 - ▶ Example: finding order statistics.

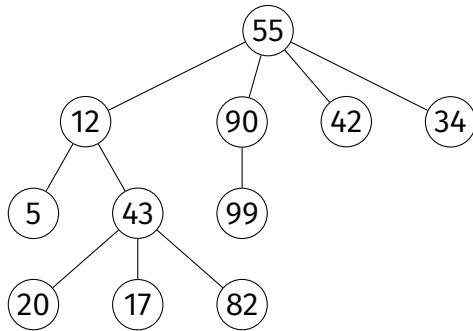
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Lecture 4 | Part 4

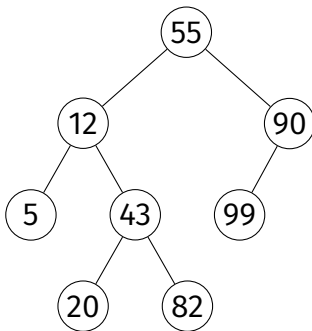
Binary Search Trees

Trees



Binary Trees

- Each node has *at most* two children (left and right).



Binary Search Tree

- ▶ A **binary search tree** (BST) is a binary tree that satisfies the following for any node x :

- ▶ if y is in x 's **left** subtree:

$$y.\text{key} \leq x.\text{key}$$

- ▶ if y is in x 's **right** subtree:

$$y.\text{key} \geq x.\text{key}$$

Assumption (for simplicity)

- ▶ We'll assume keys are unique (no duplicates).

- ▶ if y is in x 's **left** subtree:

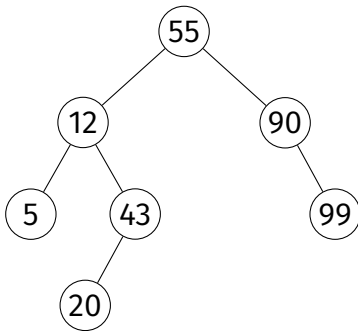
$$y.\text{key} < x.\text{key}$$

- ▶ if y is in x 's **right** subtree:

$$y.\text{key} > x.\text{key}$$

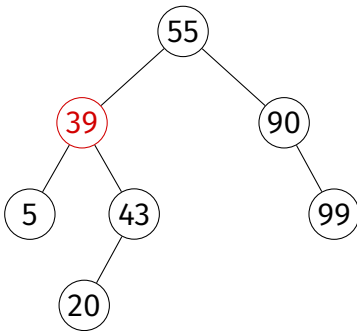
Example

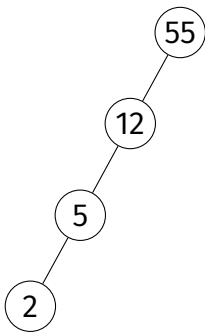
- This **is** a BST.



Example

- This is **not** a BST.





Exercise

Is this is a BST?

Height

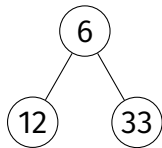
- ▶ The **height** of a tree is the number of edges from the root to any leaf.
- ▶ Suppose a binary tree has n nodes.
- ▶ The **tallest** it can be is $\approx n$
- ▶ The **shortest** it can be is $\approx \log_2 n$

In Python

```
class Node:
    def __init__(self, key, parent=None):
        self.key = key
        self.parent = parent
        self.left = None
        self.right = None

class BinarySearchTree:
    def __init__(self, root: Node):
        self.root = root
```

In Python



```
root = Node(6)
n1 = Node(12, parent=root)
root.left = n1
n2 = Node(33, parent=root)
root.right = n2
tree = BinarySearchTree(root)
```

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Design and Analysis of Algorithms I

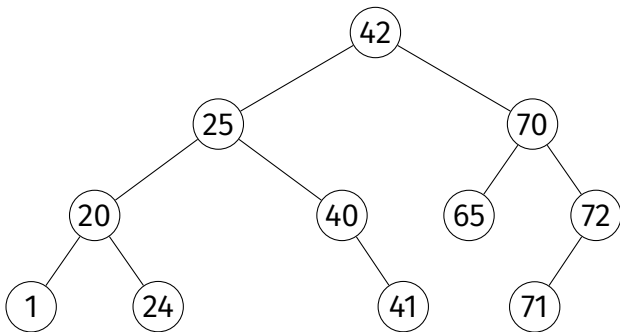
Lecture 4 | Part 5

Queries and Insertions in BSTs

Operations on BSTs

- ▶ We will want to:
 - ▶ **traverse** the nodes in sorted order by key
 - ▶ **query** a key (is it in the tree?)
 - ▶ **insert** a new key
 - ▶ **delete** an existing key

Inorder Traversal



Exercise

Implement `inorder` recursively so that it prints the keys of the nodes in the tree in sorted order.

```
def inorder(node):  
    if node is not None:  
        inorder(node.left)  
        print(node.key)  
        inorder(node.right)
```

Inorder Traversal

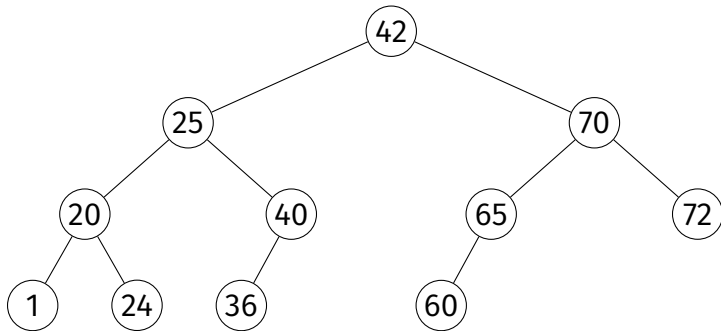
- ▶ Prints nodes in sorted order.
- ▶ Visits each node once, $\Theta(1)$ time in the call.
- ▶ Takes $\Theta(n)$ time.

Queries

- ▶ **Given:** a BST and a target, t .
- ▶ **Return:** **True** or **False**, is the target in the collection?

Queries

- Is 36 in the tree? 65? 23?



Queries

- ▶ Start walking from root.
- ▶ If current node is:
 - ▶ equal to target, return **True**;
 - ▶ too large ($>$ target), follow left edge;
 - ▶ too small ($<$ target), follow right edge;
 - ▶ **None**, return **False**

Queries, in Python

```
def query(self, target):  
    """As method of BinarySearchTree."""  
    current_node = self.root  
    while current_node is not None:  
        if current_node.key == target:  
            return current_node  
        elif current_node.key < target:  
            current_node = current_node.right  
        else:  
            current_node = current_node.left  
    return None
```

Exercise

Complete the recursive version of query.

```
def query_recursive(node, target):  
    """As a 'free function'."""  
    if node is None:  
        return False  
  
    if node.key == target:  
        ...  
    elif ...:  
        ...  
    else:  
        ...
```

Queries (Recursive)

```
def query_recursive(node, target):  
    """As a 'free function'."""  
    if node is None:  
        return False  
  
    if node.key == target:  
        return node  
    elif node.key < target:  
        return query_recursive(node.right, target)  
    else:  
        return query_recursive(node.left, target)
```

Queries, Analyzed

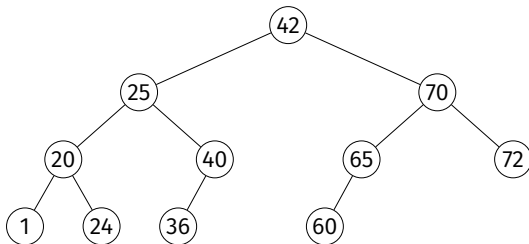
- ▶ Best case: $\Theta(1)$.
- ▶ Worst case: $\Theta(h)$, where h is **height** of tree.

Insertion

- ▶ **Given:** a BST and a new key, k .
- ▶ **Modify:** the BST, inserting k .
- ▶ Must **maintain** the BST properties.

Insertion

- Insert 23 into the BST.



Insertion (The Idea)

- ▶ Traverse the tree as in query to find empty spot where new key should go, keeping track of last node seen.
- ▶ Create new node; make last node seen the parent, update parent's children.
- ▶ Be careful about inserting into empty tree!

```
def insert(self, new_key):  
    # assume new_key is unique  
    current_node = self.root  
    parent = None  
  
    # find place to insert the new node  
    while current_node is not None:  
        parent = current_node  
        if current_node.key < new_key:  
            current_node = current_node.right  
        else: # current_node.key > new_key  
            current_node = current_node.left  
  
    # create the new node  
    new_node = Node(key=new_key, parent=parent)  
  
    # if parent is None, this is the root. Otherwise, update the  
    # parent's left or right child as appropriate  
    if parent is None:  
        self.root = new_node  
    elif parent.key < new_key:  
        parent.right = new_node  
    else:  
        parent.left = new_node
```


Insertion, Analyzed

- ▶ Worst case: $\Theta(h)$, where h is **height** of tree.

Main Idea

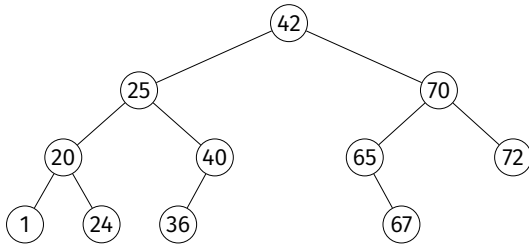
Querying and insertion take $\Theta(h)$ time in the worst case, where h is the height of the tree.

Deletion

- ▶ **Given:** a key in the BST.
- ▶ **Modify:** the BST, deleting the key.
- ▶ Must **maintain** the BST properties.
- ▶ This is a little trickier.

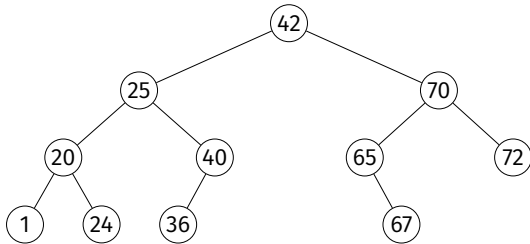
Deletion: Case 1 (Easy)

- Delete 36 from the BST.



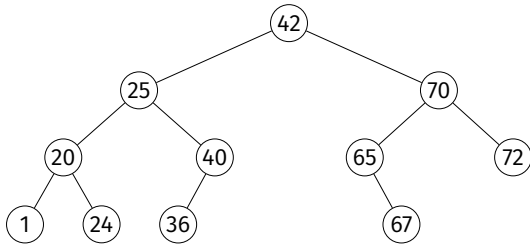
Deletion: Case 2 (Also Easy)

- **Exercise:** Delete 65 from the BST.



Deletion: Case 3 (Tricky)

- Delete 42 from the BST.

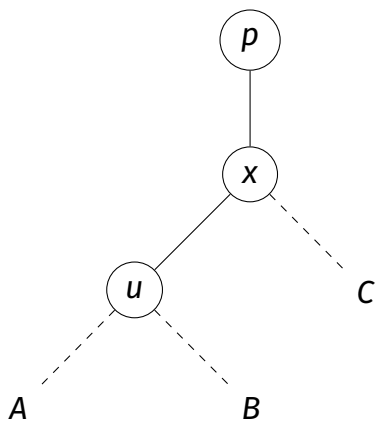


Deletion

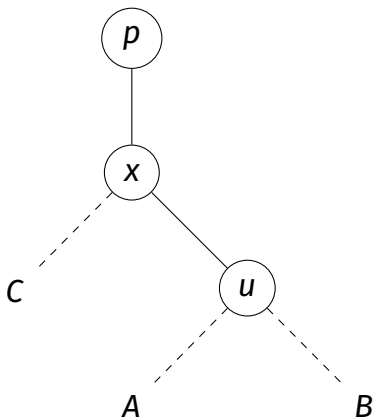
- ▶ If node has no children (leaf), **easy**.
- ▶ If node has one child, also **easy**.
- ▶ Otherwise, a little trickier.
- ▶ Idea: **rotate**² node to bottom, preserving BST. When it is a leaf or has one child, delete it.

²Most books take a different approach with the same time complexity.

(Right) Rotation



(Left) Rotation



Claim

Left rotate and right rotate preserve the BST property.

```
def _right_rotate(self, x):  
    u = x.left  
    B = u.right  
    C = x.right  
    p = x.parent  
  
    x.left = B  
    if B is not None: B.parent = x  
  
    u.right = x  
    x.parent = u  
  
    u.parent = p  
  
    if p is None:  
        self.root = u  
    elif p.left is x:  
        p.left = u  
    else:  
        p.right = u
```

Deletion Analyzed

- ▶ Each rotate takes $\Theta(1)$ time.
- ▶ $O(h)$ rotations until node becomes leaf.
- ▶ So $\Theta(h)$ time in the worst case.

Main Idea

Insertion, deletion, and querying all take $\Theta(h)$ time in the worst case, where h is the height of the tree.

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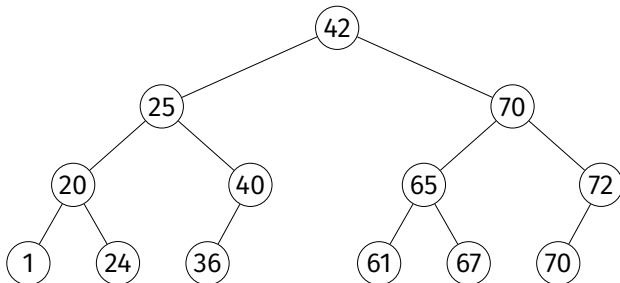
Design and Analysis of Algorithms I

Lecture 4 | Part 6

Balanced and Unbalanced BSTs

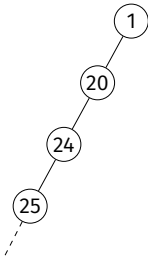
Binary Tree Height

- ▶ In case of very balanced tree, $h = \Theta(\log n)$.
 - ▶ Query, insertion take worst case $\Theta(\log n)$ time in a **balanced** tree.



Binary Tree Height

- ▶ In the case of very unbalanced tree, $h = \Theta(n)$.
 - ▶ Query, insertion take worst case $\Theta(n)$ time in **unbalanced** trees.



Unbalanced Trees

- Occurs if we insert items in (close to) sorted or reverse sorted order.

Example

- ▶ Insert 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8 (in that order).

Time Complexities

query	$\Theta(h)$
insertion	$\Theta(h)$

Where h is height, and $h = \Omega(\log n)$ and $h = O(n)$.

Time Complexities (Balanced)

query	$O(\log n)$
insertion	$O(\log n)$
deletion	$O(\log n)$

Where h is height, and $h = \Omega(\log n)$ and $h = O(n)$.

Worst Case Time Complexities (Unbalanced)

query	$\Theta(n)$
insertion	$\Theta(n)$
deletion	$\Theta(n)$

- ▶ The worst case is **bad**.
 - ▶ Worse than using a sorted array!
- ▶ The worst case is **not rare**.

Main Idea

The operations take linear time in the worst case **unless** we can somehow ensure that the tree is **balanced**.

Self-Balancing Trees

- ▶ There are variants of BSTs that are **self-balancing**.
 - ▶ Red-Black Trees, AVL Trees, etc.
- ▶ Quite complicated to implement correctly.
- ▶ But their height is **guaranteed** to be $\sim \log n$.
- ▶ So insertion, query take $\Theta(\log n)$ in worst case.

Warning!

If asked for the time complexity of a BST operation, be careful! A common mistake is to say that insertion/query are $\Theta(\log n)$ without being told that the tree is balanced.

Main Idea

In general, insertion/query take $\Theta(h)$ time in worst case. If tree is balanced, $h = \Theta(\log n)$, so they take $\Theta(\log n)$ time. If tree is badly unbalanced, $h = O(n)$, and they can take $O(n)$ time.

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Design and Analysis of Algorithms I

Lecture 4 | Part 7

Augmenting BSTs

Modifying BSTs

- ▶ Perhaps more than most other data structures, BSTs must be modified (**augmented**) to solve unique problems.

Order Statistics

- ▶ Given n numbers, the **k th order statistic** is the k th smallest number in the collection.

Dynamic Set, Many Order Statistics

- ▶ Quickselect finds any order statistic in linear expected time.
- ▶ This is efficient for a static set.
- ▶ Inefficient if set is dynamic.

Goal

- ▶ Create a **dynamic** set data structure that supports fast computation of **any** order statistic.

BST Solution

- ▶ For each node, keep attribute `.size`, containing # of nodes in subtree rooted at current node
- ▶ Property:³ `x.size = x.left.size + x.right.size + 1`

³If a left or right child doesn't exist, consider its size zero.

Computing Sizes

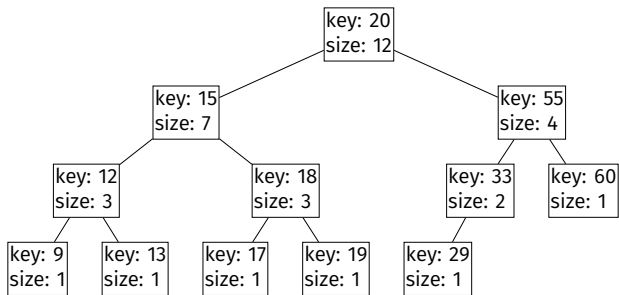
```
def add_sizes_to_tree(node):  
    if node is None:  
        return 0  
    left_size = add_sizes_to_tree(node.left)  
    right_size = add_sizes_to_tree(node.right)  
    node.size = left_size + right_size + 1  
    return node.size
```


Note

- ▶ Also need to maintain size upon inserting a node.

Computing Order Statistics

► 8th? 2nd? 12th



Augmenting Data Structures

- ▶ This is just one example, but many more.
- ▶ Understanding how BSTs work is key to augmenting them.

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Design and Analysis of Algorithms I

Lecture 4 | Part 8

Priority Queues

Priority Queues

- ▶ A **priority queue** is an abstract data type representing a collection.
- ▶ Each element has a **priority**.
- ▶ Supports operations⁴:
 - ▶ `.pop_highest_priority()`
 - ▶ `.insert(value, priority)`
 - ▶ `.is_empty()`

⁴and possibly more, like `.increase_priority`

Example

```
>>> er = PriorityQueue()
>>> er.insert('flu', priority=1)
>>> er.insert('heart attack', priority=20)
>>> er.insert('broken hand', priority=10)
>>> er.pop_highest_priority()
'heart attack'
>>> er.pop_highest_priority()
'broken hand'
```

Applications

- ▶ Scheduling.
- ▶ Useful in algorithms.
 - ▶ E.g., Prim's algorithm for Minimum Spanning Trees

Array Implementation

- ▶ We *can* implement a priority queue with a **(dynamic) array**.
- ▶ `.insert(k, p)`
 - ▶ append (value, priority) pair: $\Theta(1)$ amortized time
- ▶ `.pop_highest_priority()`
 - ▶ find entry with highest priority: $\Theta(n)$ time
 - ▶ remove it: $O(n)$ time

Exercise

What is the time needed for `.insert` and `.pop_highest_priority` if we maintain the array in **sorted order** of priority?

Array Implementation (Variant)

- ▶ Alternatively, maintain dynamic array in **sorted order** of priority.
- ▶ `.insert(k, p)`
 - ▶ find place in sorted order: $\Theta(\log n)$ time worst case
 - ▶ actually insert: $\Theta(n)$ time worst case
- ▶ `.pop_highest_priority()`
 - ▶ remove/return last entry: $\Theta(1)$ time

Main Idea

If we made no modifications, a sorted array would be great. But we want a data structure with quick remove/return even after being modified.

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Lecture 4 | Part 9

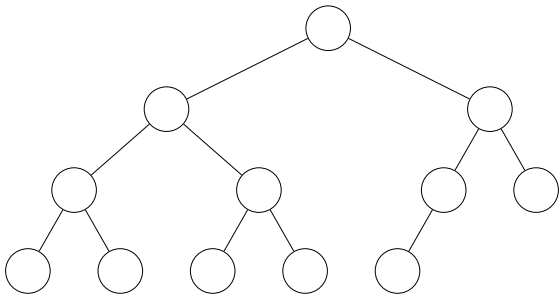
Binary Heaps

Binary Heaps

- ▶ A **binary heap** is a **binary tree** data structure often used to implement **priority queues**.

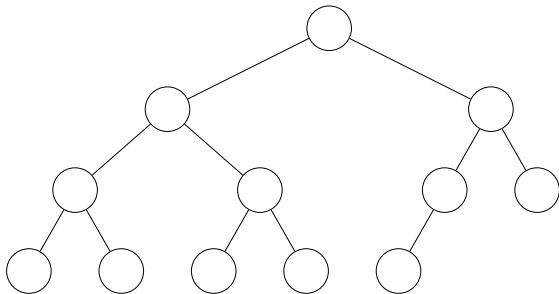
Complete Binary Trees

- ▶ A binary tree is **complete** if every level is filled, except for possibly the last (which fills from left to right).



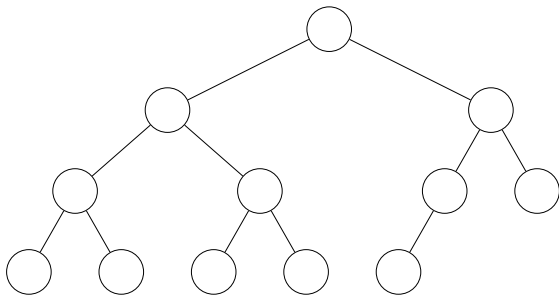
Node Height

- ▶ The **height** of node in a tree is the largest number of edges along any path to a leaf.
- ▶ The **height** of a tree is the height of the root.



Complete Tree Height

- The height of a complete binary tree with n nodes is $\Theta(\log n)$.

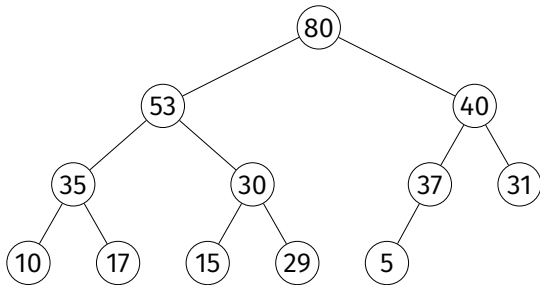


Binary Min Heap Properties

- ▶ A **binary min heap** is a binary tree with three additional properties:
 1. Each node has a **key**.
 2. **Shape**: the tree is complete.
 3. **Min-Heap**: the key of a node is $\leq$ the key of each of its children.

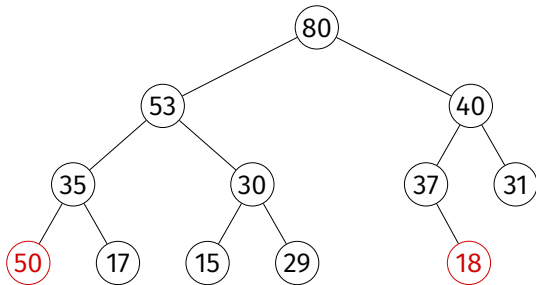
Example

- This is a binary max-heap.



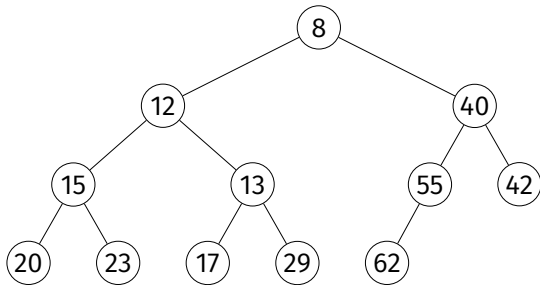
Example

- This is **not** a binary max-heap.



Example

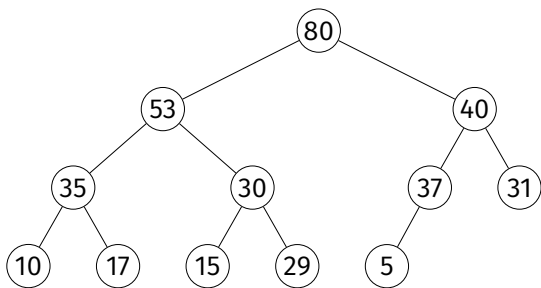
- This is a binary min-heap.



Representation

- ▶ One representation: nodes are **objects** with pointers to children.
- ▶ But due to completeness property, we can store a binary heap **compactly** in a (dynamic) array.

Array Representation



- ▶ `.left_child(i)`
- ▶ `.right_child(i)`
- ▶ `.parent(i)`



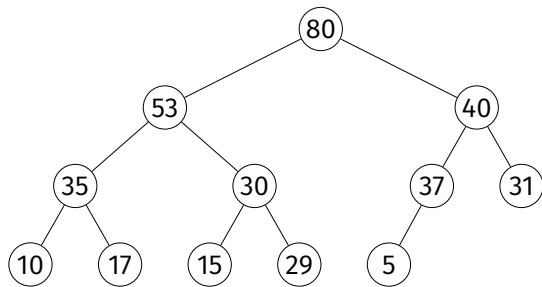
Exercise

Why would we prefer representing a binary heap with an array rather than as objects with pointers to children?

Operations

- ▶ `.max()`
 - ▶ Return (but do not remove) the max key
- ▶ `.increase_key(i, new_key)`
 - ▶ Increase key of node i , maintaining heap
- ▶ `.insert(key)`
 - ▶ Insert new node, maintaining heap
- ▶ `.pop_max()`
 - ▶ Remove max-key node, return key

.max



80	53	40	35	30	37	31	10	17	15	29	5
0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11

.max

```
class MaxHeap:
```

```
    def __init__(self, keys=None):
```

```
        if keys is None:
```

```
            keys = []
```

```
        self.keys = keys
```

```
    def max(self):
```

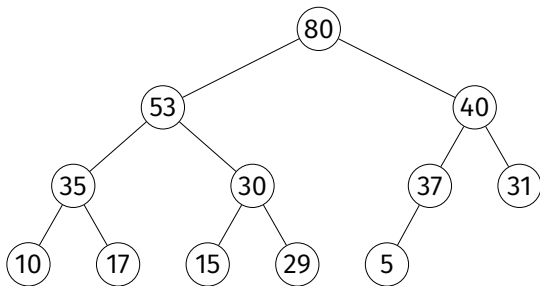
```
        return self.keys[0]
```

.max

- ▶ Takes $\Theta(1)$ time.

.increase_key

`.increase_key(9, key=60)`



80	53	40	35	30	37	31	10	17	15	29	5
0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11

.increase_key

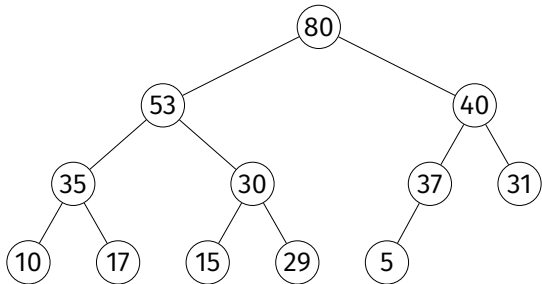
```
def increase_key(self, ix, key):  
    if key < self.keys[ix]:  
        raise ValueError('New key is smaller.')  
    self.keys[ix] = key  
    while (  
        parent(ix) >= 0  
        and  
        self.keys[parent(ix)] < key  
    ):  
        self._swap(ix, parent(ix))  
        ix = parent(ix)
```

`.increase_key`

- ▶ Takes $O(\log n)$ time.

.insert

.insert(key=60)



80	53	40	35	30	37	31	10	17	15	29	5
----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	---

0

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

11

Exercise

Implement `.insert`.

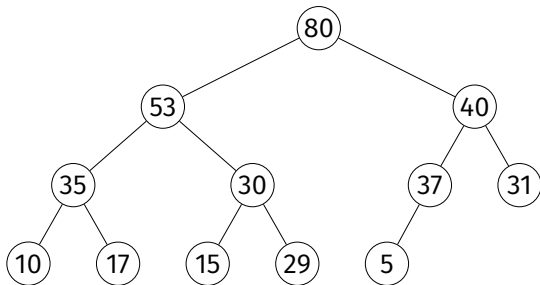
.insert

```
def insert(self, key):  
    self.keys.append(key)  
    self.increase_key(  
        len(self.keys)-1, key  
    )
```

.insert

- ▶ Takes $O(\log n)$ time (amortized).

`.pop_max_key`



80	53	40	35	30	37	31	10	17	15	29	5
0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11

.pop_max_key

```
def pop_max_key(self):  
    if len(self.keys) == 0:  
        raise IndexError('Heap is empty.')  
    highest = self.max()  
    self.keys[0] = self.keys[-1]  
    self.keys.pop()  
    self._push_down(0)  
    return highest
```

• `_push_down(i)`

- ▶ Assume that left and right subtrees of node i are max heaps, but key of i is possibly too small.
- ▶ Push it down until heap property satisfied.
 - ▶ Recursively swap with largest of left and right child.

• _push_down()

```
def _push_down(self, i):  
    left = left_child(i)  
    right = right_child(i)  
    if (  
        left < len(self.keys)  
        and  
        self.keys[left] > self.keys[i]  
    ):  
        largest = left  
    else:  
        largest = i  
  
    if (  
        right < len(self.keys)  
        and  
        self.keys[right] > self.keys[largest]  
    ):  
        largest = right  
  
    if largest != i:  
        self._swap(i, largest)  
        self._push_down(largest)
```

`.pop_max_key`

- ▶ `._push_down(i)` takes $O(h)$ where h is i 's height
- ▶ Since $h = O(\log n)$, `.pop_max_key` takes $O(\log n)$ time.

Summary

For a binary heap⁵:

.max	$\Theta(1)$
.increase_key	$O(\log n)$
.insert	$O(\log n)$
.pop_max_key	$O(h) = O(\log n)$

⁵There are other heap data structures. Fibonacci heaps have $\Theta(1)$ insert and increase key, but slower for small n .

Implementing Priority Queues

- ▶ Can use max heaps to implement priority queues.
- ▶ But a priority queue has values *and* keys.

```
pq.insert('heart attack', priority=20)
```

Trick

- ▶ Heap keys need not be integers.
- ▶ Need only be comparable.
- ▶ Can store key and value with a **tuple**.

Tuple Comparison

- ▶ In Python, tuple comparison is lexicographical.
 - ▶ Compare first entry; if tie, compare second, etc.

```
>>> (10, 'test') > (5, 'zzz')
```

```
True
```

```
>>> (10, 'test') > (10, 'zzz')
```

```
False
```

Trick

- ▶ Use 2-tuples: priority in 1st spot, value in 2nd.

```
class PriorityQueue:

    def __init__(self):
        self._heap = MaxHeap()

    def insert(self, value, priority):
        self._heap.insert((priority, value))

    def pop_highest_priority(self):
        return self._heap.pop_max()

    def max(self):
        return self._heap.max()

    def is_empty(self):
        return not bool(self._heap.keys)
```

CS-GY 6033

Design and Analysis of Algorithms I

Lecture 4 | Part 10

Example: Online Median

Online Median

- ▶ **Given:** a stream of numbers, one at a time.
- ▶ **Compute:** the median of all numbers seen so far.
- ▶ **Design:** a data structure with the following operations:
 - ▶ `.insert(number)`: in $\Theta(\log n)$ time
 - ▶ `.median()`: in $\Theta(1)$ time

Review

- ▶ Given an array, we can compute the median in:
 - ▶ $\Theta(n \log n)$ time by sorting
 - ▶ $\Theta(n)$ (expected) time with quickselect
- ▶ But modifying the array and repeating is costly.

Exercise

How could we use **two** heaps to store a collection of numbers so that the median is at the top of one of them?